

No Party Politics

Does your party align the way you think it does? 10 issues, 4 platforms, the record, and the machinery of manufactured opinion

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Prepared for the No Party Politics project. Every factual sentence links to its source. Items that could not be confirmed are marked UNVERIFIED.

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Read this first

This document does one thing. It takes the ten issues that are actually moving American politics in 2026, half of them about artificial intelligence, and puts three things next to each other for every one: what each party wrote down that it stands for, what the federal government actually did between January 2025 and September 2026, and what the voters of each party say they believe. Then it runs the gap between those three through the same clinical method a fact-checker would use on a viral post with no source attached.

The second half turns the method on the environment those posts live in. Part II documents, from indictments, sanctions notices, platform takedown reports and registered foreign-agent filings, the state-funded operations from Russia, China, Iran, Israel and the United States itself that are working to move American opinion, and how each one is using AI. Part III measures the domestic layer, the unaffiliated creators, the chatbots, and the home-grown conspiracy currents, with survey numbers rather than adjectives. Part IV gives you the method so you can run it yourself.

Rules this document follows

Every factual sentence carries a link to the source it came from. No bill number appears without its Congress number, because bill numbers repeat. No roll-call tally appears unless it was read from clerk.house.gov or senate.gov, or, where those could not be reached, from a named secondary source that is flagged as such. Where something could not be confirmed, it says UNVERIFIED rather than guessing. Where a number comes from a company with a product to sell (NewsGuard, Veriff, Cyabra) or an advocacy group with a position (American Compass, FDD, Public Citizen), that is stated next to the number. The same standard of evidence is applied to every state and every party.

Three things are kept separate throughout: what a document asserts, what is independently known, and what is inferred. Inferences are labeled as inferences.

Platforms are campaign documents. They are persuasive by design. Reading them against votes is the only way to find out whether the label on the tin matches what is inside. That is the whole exercise.

Source tiers used here

Tier 1 (primary): the platform texts themselves; Federal Register and White House executive-order texts; House Clerk and Senate roll-call pages; Supreme Court and circuit opinions; DOJ indictments and press releases; Treasury OFAC designations; FARA filings; platform company threat reports (Meta, OpenAI, Microsoft); Pew, Gallup, KFF and Reuters Institute survey pages.

Tier 2 (secondary, flagged): law-firm client alerts, CRS summaries, NPR/CBS/Axios/Roll Call reporting, Wikipedia timelines. Used where Tier 1 pages blocked automated retrieval (Congress.gov, Reuters, WSJ, NBC) and marked in the text.

Tier 3 (vendor or advocacy): counts and audits from organizations with a commercial or policy stake. Included where nothing better exists, always labeled.

The platforms compared

The 2024 Republican platform was approved by its committee on July 8, 2024 and adopted at the convention on July 15, 2024, per the notation on the [American Presidency Project](#) copy. It runs about 5,400 words. Before 2024 the last new Republican platform was 2016; in 2020 the party re-adopted the 2016 text ([Ballotpedia](#)).

The 2024 Democratic platform is roughly 43,000 words and is posted at [democrats.org](#). It was drafted and committee-approved before President Biden withdrew from the race on July 21, 2024 and adopted at the convention in August; it still refers throughout to “President Biden’s second term.” It is current as a party document and stale as a candidate statement. Keep that in mind when reading its planks.

The [Libertarian platform](#) is a numbered set of planks; the page does not state an adoption year, and the party amends it at even-year conventions, so whether the live page is the 2024 or 2026 text is UNVERIFIED. The [Green platform](#) states it was approved in July 2020 with updates in 2022 and on August 17, 2024. Independents have no platform because “independent” is not a party; the Libertarian and Green texts are the closest thing to a written third position and are included for that reason.

Part I — The ten issues

Each issue below follows the same shape. The denatured question is the issue stripped of adjectives. The platform quotes are verbatim. The record lists the two to four most consequential federal actions in the period, with vote tallies. The voter numbers are from Pew, Gallup or KFF unless stated. The dissection then tests one claim, “this party’s platform describes what this party did,” atom by atom, and closes with the viral claim shapes that most often attach to the issue and the smallest distortion each one needs to work. The retrieval line tells you where to check.

1. AI regulation and federal preemption of state AI laws

Denatured question. Should the federal government set the rules for AI, and should those rules override the states?

Democratic platform (Chapter Eight, “Seizing the Promise and Managing the Risks of AI”): “We need to act now and act fast to realize the promise of AI and manage its risks to ensure that AI serves the public interest.” “President Biden issued a landmark Executive Order directing federal agencies to establish new high standards for AI safety and security, protect Americans’ privacy, advance equity and civil rights, stand up for workers and consumers, promote competitive markets for AI development and use, and more.” “We will invest in the AI Safety Institute to create guidelines, tools, benchmarks, and best practices for evaluating dangerous capabilities and mitigating AI risk.” Silent on preemption of state law.

Republican platform (Chapter Three, “Champion Innovation — Artificial Intelligence”): “We will repeal Joe Biden’s dangerous Executive Order that hinders AI Innovation, and imposes Radical Leftwing ideas on the development of this technology. In its place, Republicans support AI Development rooted in Free Speech and Human Flourishing.” Silent on preemption of state law.

Libertarian (plank 1.2): “We support full freedom of expression and oppose government censorship, regulation, or control of communications media and technology.” No plank mentions AI. **Green:** no AI plank; the technology section calls for breaking up software monopolies and a halt to nanotechnology development pending public debate ([gp.org](https://www.gp.org)).

The record, Jan 2025 - Sep 2026.

[EO 14179](#), signed January 23, 2025, revoked the Biden AI order and directed agencies to “suspend, revise, or rescind” actions taken under it. The Republican plank was executed in the first week.

On July 1, 2025 the Senate voted 99–1 to strip a ten-year moratorium on state AI enforcement from the reconciliation bill. [Senate Vote 363](#), Blackburn Amendment 2814: 49 Republicans, 48 Democrats and both independents voted to strike it; Senator Tillis (R-NC) was the sole no. The stricken text would have tied \$42 billion in broadband funds to the pause, per [Senate Commerce Democrats](#). The underlying bill, H.R. 1 (119th), then passed

the Senate 50-50 with the Vice President breaking the tie ([Vote 372](#); Republican noes Paul, Collins, Tillis) and the House 218-214 ([Roll Call 190](#); Republican noes Fitzpatrick and Massie; Democrats 0-212), and was signed July 4, 2025.

On July 23, 2025 the White House released [America's AI Action Plan](#), which states that federal AI funding should not go "toward states with burdensome AI regulations," and signed [EO 14319](#), which requires federal agencies to buy only language models that meet "Truth-Seeking" and "Ideological Neutrality" standards, the latter defined as not manipulating "responses in favor of ideological dogmas such as DEI."

On December 11, 2025 [EO 14365](#) created a DOJ AI Litigation Task Force to challenge state AI laws, ordered Commerce to list "onerous" state laws, made such states ineligible for remaining broadband funds, and directed FTC and FCC actions toward a preemptive federal standard. The Commerce evaluation, FTC statement, FCC proceeding and broadband notice all missed their March 11, 2026 deadlines ([Proskauer](#), secondary). DOJ joined xAI's suit against Colorado's AI Act on April 24, 2026 ([Jenner & Block](#), secondary). The FTC published a [proposed policy statement](#) on July 1, 2026 asserting that state laws requiring altered model outputs are "impliedly preempted." No federal preemption statute has been enacted as of this writing.

What voters believe. Republicans and Democrats are now equally likely to say they are more concerned than excited about AI (50% and 51%, [Pew, June 2025](#)). They split on who should act: 54% of Republicans and 36% of Democrats trust the federal government to regulate AI effectively (same source, March 2025), and by February 2026, 74% of Democrats and 61% of Republicans were not confident in government regulation of AI ([Pew, Americans and AI 2026](#)). An NBC News poll fielded Aug 20 - Sept 1, 2026 found 81% say government is not doing enough to regulate AI, with Democrats trusted on the issue by 20%, Republicans by 16%, and "neither" by 44% ([via KYMA](#); NBC's own page blocked retrieval).

Dissection.

Atom 1.1 — "The Republican platform promised to repeal the Biden AI order." Factual, verifiable-primary, load-bearing. ACCURATE; done January 23, 2025.

Atom 1.2 — "The Republican platform promised to preempt state AI laws." Statutory-content claim. FALSE as to the platform: the text is silent. The preemption push comes from the administration, not the platform, and 49 of 50 voting Senate Republicans voted against the first attempt.

Atom 1.3 — "Democrats want heavy AI regulation." Evaluative. The platform's operative commitments are an executive order (since revoked), a safety institute investment, and a voice-impersonation ban. It never proposes a licensing regime or a statute. PARTIALLY-ACCURATE at best; the adjective does the work.

Atom 1.4 — "The AI moratorium passed" or "Congress banned state AI laws." Procedural. FALSE; the smallest distortion is amendment-adopted-to-strike framed as provision-enacted.

Verdict on “platform = record”: for Republicans, ACCURATE on the repeal and beyond-the-platform on preemption (confidence High; roll call settles it). For Democrats, INDETERMINATE-PENDING-SOURCE on the AI Safety Institute plank; the body was reorganized under the new administration and the current status was not confirmed in this pass (UNVERIFIED).

Viral claim shapes to watch: “Congress voted to let AI companies do whatever they want for ten years” (introduced framed as enacted; the reverse happened); “Trump banned state AI laws” (executive order framed as statute; EO 14365 directs litigation and funding conditions, it cannot repeal a state law); “Colorado’s AI law was struck down” (suit filed framed as suit won; UNVERIFIED as of this writing, check the D. Colo. docket).

Retrieval: Senate Vote 363 and 372; House Roll Call 190; Federal Register for EO 14179 and 14365; D. Colo. docket for the xAI/DOJ v. Colorado case.

2. AI in elections, deepfakes and synthetic media

Denatured question. Has the federal government restricted AI-generated political media?

Democratic platform (“Seizing the Promise and Managing the Risks of AI”): AI “is also being used to clone voices, commit fraud, institutionalize bias, and undermine democracy.” “We will also ban voice impersonations.” No plank uses the word “deepfake.”

Republican platform: silent on synthetic media. Nearest text (Chapter Eight, “Election Integrity”): “We will implement measures to secure our Elections, including Voter ID, highly sophisticated paper ballots, proof of Citizenship, and same day Voting.”

Libertarian: plank 1.2 opposes “government censorship, regulation, or control of communications media and technology”; no deepfake plank. **Green:** calls for “publicly-owned, open source voting equipment” and “verifiable paper ballots,” and its media plank says “Oppose censorship in the arts, media, press and on the Internet” ([gp.org](https://www.gp.org)); no deepfake plank.

The record.

The [TAKE IT DOWN Act](#), S. 146 (119th), was signed May 19, 2025. It criminalizes intentional publication of nonconsensual intimate images including AI-generated ones and requires platforms to remove them within 48 hours of notice. The Senate passed it by unanimous consent February 13, 2025; the House passed it 409–2 on April 28, 2025 ([Roll Call 104](#); noes Burlison and Massie). It is the only enacted federal deepfake statute in the period. It is not about elections.

The DEFIANCE Act, S. 1837 (119th), a civil cause of action for victims of sexual deepfakes, passed the Senate by unanimous consent January 13, 2026 ([Durbin release](#)); no House floor vote was found.

The Federal Election Commission lost its quorum on April 30, 2025 with three commissioners remaining ([Perkins Coie](#), secondary). Two nominees went to the Senate in February 2026; whether a quorum has been restored as of September 2026 is UNVERIFIED. In September 2024 the FEC had already [declined an AI-specific rulemaking](#), issuing only an interpretive rule that the existing fraudulent-misrepresentation statute is “technology neutral.” There is no federal disclosure requirement for AI-generated political ads.

The FCC ruled in February 2024 that AI-cloned voices are “artificial” under the robocall statute ([FCC](#)). Its August 2024 proposed rule on AI disclosure in broadcast political ads has no confirmed final action (UNVERIFIED).

The states filled the gap. Public Citizen counted [30 states](#) with election-deepfake laws as of May 13, 2026; Ballotpedia counted [31](#) in April 2026 under its own definition. EO 14365’s carve-outs (child safety, data-center infrastructure, state procurement) do not include election-deepfake laws ([Stanford CIS](#)), so those laws are within the preemption effort’s stated scope.

Both major parties’ organs used AI-generated media of opponents in 2025. The NRSC posted an AI video of Senator Schumer on October 17, 2025, watermarked “AI GENERATED” ([NPR](#)); Rep. Mike Collins’s Senate campaign posted an AI-audio video of Senator Ossoff in November 2025 with a small disclaimer ([CBS Atlanta](#)). No equivalent Democratic party-organ deepfake was found in the sources fetched; claims that either side “leads” are UNVERIFIED.

The one domestic prosecution is instructive. The consultant behind the January 2024 AI-cloned Biden robocall in New Hampshire was fined \$6 million by the FCC ([FCC NAL](#)), acquitted by a state jury on all 22 counts on June 13, 2025 ([NHPR](#)), and hit with a civil default judgment and injunction on November 21, 2025 ([Free Speech for People](#)). No federal criminal statute squarely covers domestic AI voter deception.

What voters believe. In the 2024 cycle 57% were extremely or very concerned that AI would be used to spread fake information about candidates, with no partisan gap (Republicans 56%, Democrats 58%; [Pew, Sept 2024](#)). No 2025–26 party split on deepfakes specifically was located. In September 2026, 64% told NBC that AI will do more harm than good for democracy and elections (KYMA write-up above).

Dissection.

Atom 2.1 — “Congress passed a law against deepfakes.” Statutory-content. ACCURATE-BUT-MISLEADING when used about elections: the law covers intimate imagery only.

Atom 2.2 — “The federal government regulates AI in political ads.” FALSE. The FEC declined, then lost its quorum. The states do.

Atom 2.3 — “Democrats/Republicans banned election deepfakes.” FALSE at the federal level for both. Neither platform contains the commitment and neither party has moved a bill to the floor.

Verdict on “platform = record”: both major platforms are silent on election deepfakes and the federal record matches that silence. ACCURATE (the silence is faithfully executed), confidence High.

Viral claim shapes: “It is now illegal to make a deepfake of a politician” (state law framed as federal, or intimate-imagery law framed as political); “The FEC ruled AI ads are legal” (declined rulemaking framed as affirmative permission); “That video of [candidate] is real, it’s on the news” (see Part II on fabricated outlets with real-network logos).

Retrieval: House Roll Call 104; Federal Register 2024-21979 (FEC interpretive rule); Public Citizen tracker for your state; FEC commissioner roster for quorum status.

3. AI, jobs and automation

Denatured question. Has the federal government done anything about AI-driven job displacement?

Democratic platform: “Democrats are committed to ensuring that workers get a voice in how AI is used in their workplace and that they share fairly in any economic gains AI produces.”

Republican platform: silent on AI and jobs. Nearest text: “Republicans will pave the way for future Economic Greatness by leading the World in Emerging Industries.”

Libertarian (plank 2.11): “Employment and compensation agreements between private employers and employees are outside the scope of government.” **Green:** supports “a reduced-hour (30-35 hours) work week as a standard” ([gp.org](#)); no automation plank.

The record.

[EO 14277](#), April 23, 2025, created a White House task force on AI education and a Presidential AI Challenge. The AI Action Plan (July 2025) states “AI will improve the lives of Americans by complementing their work—not replacing it” and contains retraining guidance but no displacement program. The AI-Related Job Impacts Clarity Act, S. 3108 (119th), introduced by Senators Warner (D) and Hawley (R), would require large employers to report AI-attributed layoffs; no committee or floor action was found. In March 2026 a bipartisan group asked BLS to add AI questions to its labor surveys ([Warner release](#)). No federal statute on AI displacement, workplace AI, or worker voice in AI deployment was enacted in the period; treat that as absence of evidence after search, not proof of absence.

What voters believe. 71% expect AI to lead to fewer jobs over the next twenty years, up from 64% in 2024 ([Pew, June 2026](#); no party split reported). Gallup-Bentley 2026 puts it at 79% ([Gallup](#)). The public is far more worried than AI experts: 56% of adults versus 25% of experts are extremely or very concerned about AI eliminating jobs ([Pew, April 2025](#)).

Dissection.

Atom 3.1 — “Democrats have a plan for AI job losses.” The platform has a sentence about worker voice; the legislative record has a reporting bill with no movement. PARTIALLY-ACCURATE; “plan” overstates a plank.

Atom 3.2 — “Republicans are doing nothing about AI and jobs.” The record shows AI-education and apprenticeship actions, not displacement policy. MISLEADING as phrased; ACCURATE if narrowed to displacement compensation.

Atom 3.3 — “AI has already taken X million American jobs.” Statistical. The federal government does not yet collect the data (the point of the March 2026 BLS letter); any specific figure is UNVERIFIED by construction and usually a vendor or consultancy projection.

Verdict on “platform = record”: both parties, INDETERMINATE-PENDING-SOURCE with a lean toward “neither platform has been tested,” because no displacement legislation has reached a vote. Confidence Medium.

Viral claim shapes: any hard number of “jobs lost to AI” (denominator and attribution are unmeasured); “the White House says AI will not replace jobs” (accurate quote from the Action Plan; it is an aspiration, not a finding).

Retrieval: BLS for whether AI questions were added to CPS/JOLTS; Congress.gov for S. 3108 (119th) status.

4. AI data centers, energy demand and permitting

Denatured question. Who pays for the electricity and grid that AI data centers need, and who decides how fast they get built?

Democratic platform (Chapter Four): “We will improve and speed up the processes of environmental review and clean-energy permitting; and further scale up development of clean energy on public lands.” The string “data center” does not appear.

Republican platform (Chapter Three): “Republicans will increase Energy Production across the board, streamline permitting, and end market-distorting restrictions on Oil, Natural Gas, and Coal.” The string “data center” does not appear.

Libertarian (plank 2.3): “government should not be subsidizing any particular form of energy. We oppose all government control of energy pricing, allocation, and production.”

Green: phase out “nuclear and coal power plants,” a “halt to all new fossil fuel infrastructure,” and “Decentralize the Grid” ([gp.org](https://greenparty.org)); no data-center plank.

The record.

[EO 14318](#), July 23, 2025, defines “Qualifying Projects” (over 100 MW of new AI load or \$500 million of capital), orders agencies to find NEPA categorical exclusions, opens federal and Superfund sites, and offers loans and offtake support.

DOE sent FERC a directive on large-load interconnection on October 23, 2025; on June 18, 2026 FERC issued show-cause orders to the six grid operators defining “large loads” as over 50 MW and demanding 60- to 90-day study timelines and cost-recovery rules ([White & Case](#), secondary; no final rule as of that alert).

The SPEED Act, H.R. 4776 (119th), which narrows NEPA review and judicial review, passed the House 221–196 on December 18, 2025 ([Roll Call 356](#); Republicans 210–1, Democrats 11–195). It has not moved in the Senate.

[Proclamation 11014](#), the “Ratepayer Protection Pledge,” March 4, 2026, states that “hyperscalers and AI companies that increase electricity demand must pay for the full cost of the energy and infrastructure needed” and lists Amazon, Google, Meta, Microsoft, OpenAI, Oracle and xAI as signatories. It is a pledge, not a rule.

What voters believe. This is the one AI issue where the partisan split runs the opposite way from most. 70% oppose a data center in their area; strong opposition is 56% among Democrats and 39% among Republicans ([Gallup, March 2026](#)). 50% of Democrats and 31% of Republicans say data centers are mostly bad for the environment ([Pew, Jan 2026](#)). Note from Part II: OpenAI documented a PRC-linked campaign in June 2026 posing as Americans and pushing the claim that data-center buildouts raise family electricity bills, which tells you this specific grievance is being farmed from outside as well as felt at home.

Dissection.

Atom 4.1 — “Republicans promised to fast-track data centers.” The platform says “streamline permitting” for energy generally; data centers are an executive extension. ACCURATE in spirit, beyond-the-text in specifics.

Atom 4.2 — “Democrats oppose permitting reform.” The platform explicitly supports speeding up clean-energy permitting; House Democrats voted 11–195 against the SPEED Act, which is not clean-energy-specific. ACCURATE-BUT-MISLEADING; the vote was on scope, the platform is on speed.

Atom 4.3 — “Data centers are raising your electric bill.” Causal. Plausible in specific service territories, unmeasured nationally, and actively promoted by a foreign operation. INDETERMINATE-PENDING-SOURCE; check your utility’s rate case, not a meme.

Verdict on “platform = record”: Republicans ACCURATE (executive route), Democrats PARTIALLY-ACCURATE. Confidence Medium.

Viral claim shapes: “Congress passed the SPEED Act” (one chamber framed as Congress); “Big Tech signed a binding agreement to pay for the grid” (pledge framed as rule); “[State]’s new data center will double your bill” (the PRC “Data Center Bandwagon” template, see Part II).

Retrieval: House Roll Call 356; FERC docket for the June 2026 show-cause orders; your state PUC’s rate-case filings.

5. AI and national security: China and chip export controls

Denatured question. Is the United States restricting or permitting the sale of advanced AI chips to China?

Democratic platform (Chapter Nine, “Indo-Pacific”): President Biden “tightened restrictions on the export of artificial intelligence chips and manufacturing equipment, as well as semiconductor, artificial intelligence, and quantum computing technologies to China, stifling their military use of these technologies.”

Republican platform (Chapter Five): “Republicans will revoke China’s Most Favored Nation status, phase out imports of essential goods, and stop China from buying American Real Estate and Industries.” Silent on chip export controls.

Libertarian (plank 3.3): end “foreign intervention including military and economic aid; tariffs; economic sanctions; and regime change.” **Green:** “prohibit all arms sales to foreign nations” ([gp.org](https://www.gp.org)); no chip plank.

The record.

On May 13, 2025 the Commerce Department [rescinded the Biden “AI Diffusion Rule”](#) two days before its compliance date. Nvidia’s H20 chip was put under license in April 2025, then licensed in July 2025 with a reported 15% revenue-share arrangement (secondary timeline, UNVERIFIED against a primary document). On December 8, 2025 the President announced H200 sales to approved Chinese customers with “25 percent of the revenue” to the U.S. government ([CFR](#), secondary). A [BIS rule](#) on January 15, 2026 moved H200-class chips to China from presumption of denial to case-by-case review, conditioned on certifications that exports “won’t exceed 50 percent” of U.S. shipments and on no military end use; a Section 232 proclamation the day before imposed a 25% tariff on narrowly defined advanced chips, the mechanism for the fee ([White & Case](#), secondary).

The FY2026 NDAA, signed December 18, 2025, expanded outbound-investment restrictions on semiconductors, AI and quantum. The Senate-passed GAIN AI Act, which would have given U.S. buyers priority for advanced chips, was dropped in conference; Nvidia and the Semiconductor Industry Association opposed it ([Nextgov](#), secondary).

What voters believe. 71% view China unfavorably; 44% of Republicans and 14% of Democrats call it an “enemy” ([Pew, 2026](#)). On chips specifically, a YouGov poll for American Compass (an advocacy group; May 2026) found 67% of Republicans and 50% of Democrats support a complete ban on advanced AI chip sales to China ([American Compass](#)). No Pew or Gallup item on chip controls was found.

Dissection.

Atom 5.1 — “Republicans are tough on China tech.” The platform’s China plank is about trade status and asset purchases. The record on chips moved from restriction toward licensed sales with a revenue share. PARTIALLY-ACCURATE; the platform and the chip record point in different directions, and the platform never mentioned chips.

Atom 5.2 — “Democrats tightened chip controls.” ACCURATE as a description of 2022–2024; the platform’s plank was reversed in May 2025 by the rescission.

Atom 5.3 — “The U.S. is selling China the chips it needs to beat us.” Evaluative/predictive with a factual core. The core, licensed H20/H200 sales with a fee, is ACCURATE; the conclusion is unfalsifiable and depends on assumptions about the chips’ capability tier.

Verdict on “platform = record”: Republicans, the chip record runs beyond and arguably against the platform’s “strategic independence” framing (inference); Democrats, the platform plank was undone by the succeeding administration and never tested by a Democratic vote. Confidence Medium; the revenue-share arrangements rest on secondary sources.

Viral claim shapes: “Trump banned/unbanned all chip sales to China” (neither; case-by-case with conditions); “Congress passed a law giving China our chips” (executive licensing framed as statute); “Nvidia pays a 25% bribe” (a Section 232 tariff framed as something else; the mechanism is public and lawful whatever one thinks of it).

Retrieval: Federal Register 2026-00789; BIS press releases; the Section 232 proclamation of January 14, 2026; Nvidia SEC filings for the H20 terms.

6. Immigration and the border

Denatured question. What did the federal government do on enforcement, deportation and legal pathways, and what did the courts allow?

Democratic platform (Chapter Seven): the President “will push Congress to provide the resources and authorities that we need to secure the border,” including “additional border patrol agents, immigration judges, asylum officers.” It supports emergency authority “to expel migrants who are crossing unlawfully and stop processing asylum claims” when the system is overwhelmed, and the U.S. Citizenship Act to “permanently increase family-sponsored and employment-based immigration.”

Republican platform (Chapter Two, “Seal the Border, and Stop the Migrant Invasion”): “restore every Border Policy of the Trump administration and halt all releases of Illegal Aliens into the interior”; “invoke the Alien Enemies Act to remove all known or suspected gang members, drug dealers, or cartel members”; “Begin Largest Deportation Program in American History”; “cut federal Funding to sanctuary jurisdictions.”

Libertarian (plank 3.4): “Economic freedom demands the unrestricted movement of human as well as financial capital across national borders.” **Green:** legal status with a path to citizenship for undocumented residents; immediate citizenship access for DACA and TPS holders ([gp.org](https://greenparty.org)).

The record.

The [Laken Riley Act](#), S. 5 (119th), signed January 29, 2025, requires DHS to detain non-citizens charged with theft. Senate 64-35 ([Vote 7](#); Republicans 49-0, Democrats 14-31); House 263-156 ([Roll Call 23](#); Republicans 217-0, Democrats 46-156).

H.R. 1 (119th), July 4, 2025, appropriated roughly \$170 billion for immigration and border enforcement, including \$45 billion for ICE detention and \$29.9 billion for ICE enforcement and removal ([American Immigration Council](#), secondary), on the party-line votes in Issue 1.

The Supreme Court in [Trump v. J.G.G.](#) (April 7, 2025) held that Alien Enemies Act detainees must bring habeas claims where they are held and are “entitled to notice and opportunity to be heard”; in [Trump v. CASA](#) (June 27, 2025, 6-3) it curtailed universal injunctions; and in [Trump v. Barbara](#) (June 30, 2026) it held that children born in the United States to parents “unlawfully or temporarily present ... are citizens at birth,” striking the birthright-citizenship order (exact justice alignment UNVERIFIED in this pass).

The Secure America Act, S. 2 (119th), a second reconciliation bill with about \$70 billion for ICE and Border Patrol, was signed June 10, 2026 after DHS appropriations talks broke down. Senate 52-47 ([Vote 163](#); Murkowski the only Republican no; all Democrats and independents no); House 214-212 ([Roll Call 214](#); Republicans 214-0, Democrats 0-211).

What voters believe. 52% say the administration is doing “too much” on deportations; that is 19% of Republicans and 84% of Democrats ([Pew, April 2026](#)). Marquette (Feb 2026) found 60% disapprove of ICE’s work, Republicans in favor, Democrats and independents opposed ([Marquette](#); party percentages not fetched).

Dissection.

Atom 6.1 — “Republicans did what the platform said on immigration.” ACCURATE on funding, enforcement expansion and Alien Enemies Act invocation; the courts constrained the AEA and struck the birthright order, which the platform never proposed. Confidence High.

Atom 6.2 — “Democrats oppose all border enforcement.” FALSE. 14 Senate and 46 House Democrats voted for the Laken Riley Act; the platform itself endorses emergency expulsion authority. The claim’s smallest distortion is party-line votes on the two reconciliation bills generalized to “all enforcement.”

Atom 6.3 — “The Supreme Court upheld/struck down mass deportation.” Neither. J.G.G. was about venue and notice; CASA was about remedies; Barbara was about citizenship at birth. Each is routinely misread as a substantive ruling on deportation policy.

Verdict on “platform = record”: Republicans ACCURATE; Democrats PARTIALLY-ACCURATE (the legal-pathway agenda had no vehicle; the enforcement votes split). Confidence High.

Viral claim shapes: “SCOTUS ended birthright citizenship” (reverse of Barbara); “Democrats voted to release criminals” (motion-to-recommit or procedural-vote framing on a bill they may have supported on final passage; check the roll call number); “ICE got \$X billion to build camps” (appropriation line items framed with a purpose the text does not state).

Retrieval: Senate Vote 7 and 163; House Roll Call 23 and 214; the three Supreme Court opinions above.

7. The economy: inflation, tariffs and taxes

Denatured question. Were the tariff and tax planks enacted, by what mechanism, and did the courts allow it?

Democratic platform (Chapter Three): Trump “wants to drag America backwards, with extreme import tariffs that will make life more expensive for folks nationwide.” “Democrats will protect everyone earning less than \$400,000 a year from any tax increase.” The platform also praises the Biden administration for “strategically increasing tariffs” on Chinese steel, semiconductors and EVs.

Republican platform (Chapter Five): “Republicans will support baseline Tariffs on Foreign-made goods, pass the Trump Reciprocal Trade Act, and respond to unfair Trading practices. As Tariffs on Foreign Producers go up, Taxes on American Workers, Families, and Businesses can come down.” Chapter Three: “make permanent the provisions of the Trump Tax Cuts and Jobs Act ... eliminate Taxes on Tips.”

Libertarian: repeal the income tax and abolish the IRS (plank 2.4); end tariffs (plank 3.3).

Green: exempt incomes under \$25,000 (\$50,000 for families) from income tax; impose a financial transaction tax; “fair trade” over “corporate control of ‘free trade’” ([gp.org](#)).

The record.

[EO 14257](#), April 2, 2025, declared a national emergency under IEEPA over trade deficits and imposed a 10% baseline tariff plus country-specific rates. The Senate voted 51–47 on October 30, 2025 to terminate the emergency ([Vote 600](#); four Republicans, Collins, McConnell, Murkowski and Paul, joined all Democrats); the House never took it up.

On February 20, 2026 the Supreme Court held 6–3 in [Learning Resources v. Trump](#) that “IEEPA does not authorize the President to impose tariffs” (Roberts; Thomas, Alito and Kavanaugh dissenting). Roughly \$160 billion had been collected ([Tax Foundation](#), secondary). The same day the President proclaimed a 10% global tariff under Section 122 of the Trade Act (150-day limit); the Court of International Trade invalidated that on May 7, 2026 for the named plaintiffs, and the government obtained a temporary stay on appeal ([Skadden](#), secondary). Section 232 tariffs on steel, aluminum, autos, copper and lumber and the 2018 Section 301 China tariffs were unaffected.

H.R. 1 (119th) made the 2017 individual rates permanent, raised the standard deduction to \$15,750/\$31,500, set the child credit at \$2,200 indexed, created a tips deduction up to \$25,000 and an overtime deduction up to \$12,500 through 2028, and lifted the SALT cap to \$40,000 through 2029 ([Tax Foundation](#), secondary). CBO projected \$3.4 trillion added to deficits over 2025–2034 (CBO via [AHA summary](#), secondary).

CPI for August 2026 rose 3.4% year over year, the same as July; core rose 2.4% ([BLS, Sept 11, 2026](#)).

What voters believe. 60% disapprove of the tariff increases; 71% of Republicans approve and 93% of Democrats disapprove ([Pew, Jan 2026](#)).

Dissection.

Atom 7.1 — “Republicans enacted the tax planks.” ACCURATE, nearly verbatim.

Atom 7.2 — “Republicans enacted baseline tariffs.” ACCURATE-BUT-MISLEADING: the platform promised a “Trump Reciprocal Trade Act,” a statute; the tariffs were imposed by emergency decree, which the Supreme Court held unlawful. No tariff statute was passed.

Atom 7.3 — “The Supreme Court struck down Trump’s tariffs.” PARTIALLY-ACCURATE. It struck the IEEPA tariffs; Section 232 and 301 tariffs stand; a Section 122 replacement is in litigation.

Atom 7.4 — “Democrats oppose tariffs.” ACCURATE as to the 2025 tariffs; the same platform praises Biden’s targeted China tariffs. The honest version is “Democrats oppose across-the-board tariffs.”

Atom 7.5 — “Inflation is at X%.” August 2026 headline is 3.4%. Any claim using a different figure is either a different month, a different index (core, PCE) or wrong. Level-versus-rate and start-date cherry-picking are the standard distortions here.

Verdict on “platform = record”: Republicans, taxes ACCURATE, tariffs ACCURATE on substance and FALSE on mechanism; Democrats ACCURATE on opposition. Confidence High.

Viral claim shapes: “Tariffs are dead” (IEEPA framed as all tariffs); “Trump ignored the Supreme Court” (the Section 122 proclamation was a different statutory route, itself now in court); “the tax cut only helps the rich” or “the tax cut helps everyone” (both require a distributional table with a stated year and baseline; ask for it).

Retrieval: Senate Vote 600; the Learning Resources opinion; CIT dockets for Oregon v. United States; BLS CPI release table.

8. Health care: the ACA, Medicaid and drug prices

Denatured question. Did federal action expand or reduce coverage, and what happened to drug pricing?

Democratic platform (Chapter Three): “We’ll never quit fighting to protect and expand the Affordable Care Act.” On the enhanced premium tax credits: “Republicans want to let those credits expire, increasing premiums. Democrats will fight to make them permanent.” “As Democrats, we support Medicaid expansion.” Medicare negotiation: “Democrats will push to add at least 50 drugs a year to that list.”

Republican platform (Chapter Four): “Healthcare and prescription drug costs are out of control. Republicans will increase Transparency, promote Choice and Competition, and expand access to new Affordable Healthcare and prescription drug options. We will protect Medicare.” Chapter Six: the President “will not cut one penny from Medicare or Social Security.” Silent on Medicaid and on the ACA by name.

Libertarian (plank 2.13): “We favor a free market health care system”; opposes mandating or restricting “medical treatments or procedures including vaccines.” **Green**: “a universal, comprehensive, national single-payer health care system” ([gp.org](https://www.gp.org)).

The record.

H.R. 1 (119th) imposed an 80-hours-per-month work or community-engagement requirement on Medicaid expansion adults aged 19–64, effective January 1, 2027, with six-month redeterminations ([KFF](#)). CBO projected 10 million more uninsured in 2034 and about \$1.06 trillion less federal Medicaid and Marketplace spending over the decade (CBO via AHA summary, secondary). Party-line votes in Issue 1.

The enhanced ACA premium tax credits expired December 31, 2025. A 43-day shutdown (October 1 – November 12, 2025) ended with a promise of a Senate vote; on December 11, 2025 both a Democratic three-year extension and a Republican HSA alternative failed 51–48, short of 60 ([NPR](#), secondary; Senate vote numbers not retrieved). On January 8, 2026 the House passed H.R. 1834, a three-year extension, 230–196 via discharge petition ([Roll Call 11](#); Republicans 17–196, Democrats 213–0). Senate talks stalled over Hyde language ([CBS](#)). No extension has been enacted.

[EO 14297](#), May 12, 2025, on most-favored-nation drug pricing, was followed by voluntary agreements with nine manufacturers announced December 19, 2025. These are agreements, not rules or statutes.

[Medina v. Planned Parenthood South Atlantic](#), June 26, 2025, 6–3, held that Medicaid’s any-qualified-provider provision does not confer individually enforceable rights, allowing states to exclude Planned Parenthood.

What voters believe. The ACA is viewed favorably by 58% (Democrats 91%, Republicans 22%); 67% say Congress did the “wrong thing” by not extending the credits, including 37% of Republicans and 54% of non-MAGA Republicans ([KFF, Jan 2026](#)). Medicaid work requirements are supported by 62% (Republicans 82%, Democrats 47%; [KFF, Feb 2025](#)).

Dissection.

Atom 8.1 — “Republicans didn’t cut Medicare.” ACCURATE as to H.R. 1’s direct Medicare provisions; the platform’s silence on Medicaid coincides with the largest Medicaid reduction of the period. The claim is true and the omission is the story.

Atom 8.2 — “Republicans cut health care for 10 million people.” Statistical. The 10 million is a CBO projection for 2034, not a count. PolitiFact rated Senator Sanders’s “15 million thrown off” claim Mostly False in April 2026, noting actual enrollment decline at that point

was about 1 million ([PolitiFact](#)). Projection-framed-as-count is the distortion, and it runs in both directions (“nobody lost coverage” is equally wrong; the requirement has not taken effect).

Atom 8.3 — “Democrats made the ACA credits permanent.” FALSE; they could not clear 60 votes. “Democrats fought to” is ACCURATE (shutdown, discharge petition, 213-0 House vote).

Atom 8.4 — “Trump lowered drug prices by executive order.” MISLEADING. The order set a policy; the price changes are voluntary company agreements whose terms and coverage vary.

Verdict on “platform = record”: Republicans ACCURATE on Medicare pledge, silent-then-acted on Medicaid; Democrats ACCURATE on effort, FALSE on outcome. Confidence High.

Viral claim shapes: “X million kicked off Medicaid” before 2027 (projection as count, wrong year); “Republicans voted to protect the ACA” (the 17 House Republicans on H.R. 1834 generalized to the party); “Medicare negotiation was repealed” (UNVERIFIED; no repeal located, check the statute).

Retrieval: House Roll Call 11; CBO’s July 21, 2025 letter on H.R. 1; KFF trackers; the December 11, 2025 Senate roll calls.

9. Abortion and reproductive rights

Denatured question. Did the federal government act to restrict or protect access, or leave it to the states as the Republican platform said it would?

Democratic platform (Chapter Six): “With a Democratic Congress, we will pass national legislation to make Roe the law of the land again ... We will protect a woman’s right to access IVF. We will repeal the Hyde Amendment.”

Republican platform (Chapter Eight): “We believe that the 14th Amendment to the Constitution of the United States guarantees that no person can be denied Life or Liberty without Due Process, and that the States are, therefore, free to pass Laws protecting those Rights. After 51 years, because of us, that power has been given to the States and to a vote of the People. We will oppose Late Term Abortion, while supporting mothers and policies that advance Prenatal Care, access to Birth Control, and IVF (fertility treatments).”

Libertarian: the current platform page contains no plank using the word “abortion”; the former abortion plank is absent. **Green:** “Women’s right to control their bodies is non-negotiable. It is essential that the option of a safe, legal abortion remains available” ([gp.org](#)).

The record.

[EO 14182](#), January 24, 2025, declared it federal policy “to end the forced use of Federal taxpayer dollars to fund or promote elective abortion” and revoked two Biden orders.

H.R. 1 (119th) Section 71113 barred federal Medicaid payments for one year to family-planning providers that perform abortions outside Hyde exceptions and received at least \$800,000 in Medicaid in 2023, which in practice is Planned Parenthood. A district court enjoined it; the First Circuit stayed and then vacated the injunctions on December 12, 2025, and the suits were dismissed in early 2026 ([KFF litigation tracker](#)).

On mifepristone, the Fifth Circuit on May 1, 2026 reinstated the pre-2023 in-person dispensing requirement nationwide pending appeal ([opinion](#)); the Supreme Court stayed that order on May 14, 2026, Thomas and Alito dissenting ([order](#)). The FDA had opened a safety review of the drug's REMS in September 2025 (secondary).

No federal abortion ban and no national codification bill received a floor vote in the period.

What voters believe. 60% say abortion should be legal in all or most cases; 36% of Republicans and at least 84% of Democrats; the partisan gap is 48 points, up from 24 in 2007 ([Pew, Jan 2026](#)).

Dissection.

Atom 9.1 — “Republicans left abortion to the states.” PARTIALLY-ACCURATE. No national ban was pursued. Federal action did restrict access through funding (Hyde order, Section 71113) and through the executive’s litigating position on mifepristone. “States decide” describes the legality question; it does not describe the funding and drug-access record.

Atom 9.2 — “Republicans are banning abortion nationally.” FALSE at the statutory level; no bill moved.

Atom 9.3 — “Democrats will restore Roe.” Predictive; requires a Democratic trifecta plus a filibuster change. Not tested in the period. UNFALSIFIABLE as stated.

Atom 9.4 — “Mifepristone was banned / is now mail-order only.” Both wrong. The in-person requirement was reinstated by one court and stayed by another within two weeks; the current rule is the 2023 rule while the appeal is pending. Anyone stating a settled status is behind the docket.

Verdict on “platform = record”: Republicans PARTIALLY-ACCURATE (states-decide on legality, federal action on funding and access); Democrats INDETERMINATE (no vehicle). Confidence High on the record, Medium on characterization.

Viral claim shapes: “SCOTUS ruled on mifepristone” (a stay order is not a merits ruling); “Planned Parenthood was defunded forever” (one-year provision); “the Republican platform dropped its pro-life plank” (it removed the national-ban language and kept the 14th Amendment framing; read the paragraph).

Retrieval: the First Circuit’s December 12, 2025 opinion; Supreme Court order 25A1207; H.R. 1 Section 71113 text.

10. Free speech, content moderation, Section 230 and platform regulation

Denatured question. Has the federal government changed what platforms must carry, remove or be liable for?

Democratic platform (Chapter Eight): “We must also fundamentally reform Section 230 of the Communications Decency Act, which shields tech platforms from liability even when they host or disseminate violent or illegal content.” “Democrats will pass bipartisan legislation to protect kids’ privacy ... ban targeted advertising to children.”

Republican platform (Chapter Eight, “Dismantle Censorship & Protect Free Speech”): “We will ban the Federal Government from colluding with anyone to censor Lawful Speech, defund institutions engaged in censorship, and hold accountable all bureaucrats involved with illegal censoring. We will protect Free Speech online.” Silent on Section 230 by name.

Libertarian (plank 1.2): “Language that is perceived to be offensive to certain groups or individuals is not a cause for any legal action.” **Green:** “Oppose censorship in the arts, media, press and on the Internet”; support net neutrality ([gp.org](https://www.gp.org)).

The record.

[EO 14149](#), January 20, 2025, made it federal policy that no federal employee “engages in or facilitates any conduct that would unconstitutionally abridge the free speech of any American citizen” and directed identification of “past misconduct by the Federal Government related to censorship.” The FTC opened a “tech censorship” inquiry in early 2025; at an April 3, 2025 DOJ forum the FCC chair said the agency would “push the envelope on Section 230 reform” ([Crowell & Moring](#), secondary). No FCC Section 230 rule or advisory opinion was located (UNVERIFIED absence).

The TAKE IT DOWN Act (Issue 2) is the period’s only enacted federal platform-content mandate.

The Kids Internet and Digital Safety (KIDS) Act, H.R. 7757 (119th), passed the House 267–117 on June 29, 2026 ([Roll Call 228](#); Republicans 162–32, Democrats 104–85). It bundles a KOSA-style duty of care, COPPA 2.0 with no targeted ads to minors under 14, and age verification for sites with over one-third “harmful to children” content; it does not touch Section 230 ([Tech Policy Press](#), secondary). Senate Commerce Democrats objected to its preemption language; no Senate vote as of this writing. Section 230 has not been amended.

What voters believe. Positions here have swapped with the White House. In March 2025, 51% said government should restrict false information online even at some cost to freedom; Democrats 58% (down from 70% in 2023), Republicans 43% (up from 39%). Pew notes Democratic support for government restriction peaks under Democratic presidents and troughs under Republican ones ([Pew, April 2025](#)). By June 2026, asked whether government should be able to restrict news for false information, Republicans said yes at 59% and

Democrats at 45% ([Pew, Sept 2026](#)). 59% of Republicans and 36% of Democrats say news organizations often intentionally keep important news from the public; 64% of Democrats and 53% of Republicans say the government does ([Pew](#)).

Dissection.

Atom 10.1 — “Section 230 was reformed/repealed.” FALSE for both parties. Agency officials said “reform”; no rule or statute exists.

Atom 10.2 — “Republicans protected free speech online.” The record is an executive order aimed at government conduct plus agency inquiries into platform moderation. ACCURATE as to the order’s text; whether inquiries into private moderation decisions protect or pressure speech is evaluative and contested.

Atom 10.3 — “Democrats passed kids’ online safety.” One chamber, with the party split 104-85. FALSE as stated; “House Democrats split on” is accurate.

Atom 10.4 — “Democrats/Republicans support censorship.” Each side’s voters supported government restriction of false information more when their own party held the White House. The honest generalization is about incumbency, not party.

Verdict on “platform = record”: both parties INDETERMINATE on Section 230 (no vehicle); Republicans ACCURATE on the executive-order plank; Democrats PARTIALLY-ACCURATE on kids’ privacy (House only, party split). Confidence High.

Viral claim shapes: “The FCC repealed Section 230” (a speech framed as a rule); “Congress passed KOSA” (one chamber, different bill number); “the Twitter Files / EO 14149 proved the government censored X” (an order’s stated policy framed as a finding of fact; the order directs a review, it does not make findings).

Retrieval: House Roll Call 228; Federal Register 2025-01902; FCC docket search for any Section 230 proceeding.

Scorecard

The table collapses the ten verdicts on the single claim “this party’s platform describes what this party did in office or in Congress, January 2025 to September 2026.” It is a summary of the dissections above, not a substitute for them.

Issue	Republican platform vs. record	Democratic platform vs. record
1. AI regulation / preemption	ACCURATE on repeal; preemption push is beyond the platform, and 49 of 50 Senate Republicans voted against the first attempt	INDETERMINATE (Safety Institute plank not tested; body reorganized)
2. Election deepfakes	ACCURATE (silent, and nothing enacted)	ACCURATE (silent on deepfakes; voice-impersonation ban not enacted)
3. AI and jobs	INDETERMINATE (education and apprenticeship actions; no displacement policy)	INDETERMINATE (worker-voice plank produced a reporting bill with no movement)

Issue	Republican platform vs. record	Democratic platform vs. record
4. Data centers / energy	ACCURATE (executive permitting route; Senate stalled)	PARTIALLY-ACCURATE (supports fast clean-energy permitting; voted 11-195 against SPEED)
5. China chips	PARTIALLY-ACCURATE (platform silent on chips; record moved to licensed sales with a fee)	ACCURATE for 2022-24; plank reversed by the next administration
6. Immigration	ACCURATE (courts constrained AEA, struck birthright order)	PARTIALLY-ACCURATE (14 Senate / 46 House Democrats backed Laken Riley; pathways had no vehicle)
7. Economy	Taxes ACCURATE; tariffs ACCURATE on substance, FALSE on mechanism (decree, not statute; held unlawful)	ACCURATE (opposed across-the-board tariffs; endorsed targeted ones)
8. Health care	Medicare pledge ACCURATE; Medicaid silent-then-cut	Effort ACCURATE; outcome FALSE (credits expired)
9. Abortion	PARTIALLY-ACCURATE (no national ban; federal funding and drug-access restrictions)	INDETERMINATE (no vehicle)
10. Speech / 230	EO plank ACCURATE; Section 230 INDETERMINATE	Kids' privacy PARTIALLY-ACCURATE (House only, party split); Section 230 INDETERMINATE

The pattern (inference): the Republican platform is short, and most of its concrete planks were executed, usually by executive action rather than statute, and several of the most consequential actions of the period (state-law preemption, chip revenue-share licensing, Medicaid work requirements, the birthright-citizenship order) appear nowhere in it. The Democratic platform is long, and most of its planks were never tested because the party held neither chamber nor the White House; where its members did vote, they split on enforcement and on kids' safety and held together on taxes, tariffs and health credits. A voter who thinks their party "stands for" something should check whether it is in the document, whether it was voted on, and whether the vote matched.

Part II — The manufacturing layer: state-sponsored influence operations, 2024-2026

Everything in Part I is about what the parties said and did. This part is about who is paying to shape what you think they said and did. The evidence base is indictments, sanctions designations, registered foreign-agent filings, platform takedown reports and named investigative reporting. Each state gets the same treatment. Two reading notes apply throughout.

First, nearly every platform and government assessment cited here says the operation in question got little authentic engagement. That is the rule, not the exception. Weigh “scale of attempt” separately from “measured effect.” Second, the U.S. units that produced most of the 2024 attributions (the State Department’s counter-disinformation office, the FBI’s Foreign Influence Task Force, ODNI’s Foreign Malign Influence Center, CISA’s election team) had been closed or cut by mid-2026, so the 2026 record is thinner than the 2024 record partly because fewer people are looking.

Russia

Doppelganger. The Treasury Department sanctioned the Social Design Agency and Structura on March 20, 2024 for running “over 60 websites that impersonated legitimate news organizations” ([Treasury](#)). On September 4, 2024 the Justice Department seized 32 domains (washingtonpost.pm among them) used by those firms and ANO Dialog “under the direction and control of the Russian Presidential Administration,” naming First Deputy Chief of Staff Sergei Kiriyenko; methods listed were cybersquatted news domains, AI-generated content, paid social ads and fabricated influencer profiles ([DOJ](#)). The affidavit’s internal planning documents, the “Good Old USA Project” and “Guerrilla Media Campaign,” listed target audiences by swing state (Nevada, Georgia, Arizona, Pennsylvania, Michigan, Wisconsin) and demographic, and stated that it “makes sense for Russia to put maximum effort to ensure that the [Republican Party] point of view ... wins over the U.S. public opinion,” with the operating instruction to use “a minimum of fake news and a maximum of realistic information” ([The Record](#)). OpenAI confirmed the operators used ChatGPT to generate comments in five languages ([OpenAI, May 2024](#)). Meta’s H1 2026 report says Social Design Agency offshoots and ANO Dialog networks were still active, including AI-generated personas aimed at diaspora communities in the U.S., and states: “The United States continues to be the most targeted country globally” ([Meta](#)).

RT and Tenet Media. The same day, DOJ indicted two RT employees for funneling “nearly \$10 million” (\$9.7 million in wires between October 2023 and August 2024, routed through shells in Turkey, the UAE and Mauritius and labeled as “electronics purchases”) into a Tennessee content company that published nearly 2,000 videos with more than 16 million YouTube views on immigration, inflation and foreign policy, never registering under FARA

([DOJ](#); [indictment](#)). DOJ described the American hosts as unwitting. Treasury sanctioned RT's editor-in-chief and ANO Dialog's leadership, citing the use of generative-AI deepfakes ([Treasury](#)). Case status as of September 2026: UNVERIFIED.

Storm-1516, CopyCop and the Center for Geopolitical Expertise. Microsoft attributed to Storm-1516 the staged video of a supposed assault by Harris supporters, the fabricated Harris hit-and-run story laundered through a fake San Francisco news site ([Microsoft, Sept 2024](#)), and the AI-enhanced Zambia poaching and Walz fabrications that drew “more than 5 million views on X in the first 24 hours” ([Microsoft, Oct 2024](#)). The intelligence community publicly attributed to Russia the video of purported Haitians voting illegally in Georgia and a fake Arizona fraud interview ([ODNI/FBI/CISA, Nov 1, 2024](#); [Nov 4](#)). Treasury sanctioned the GRU-linked Center for Geopolitical Expertise on December 31, 2024 for using generative AI to produce manipulated videos of U.S. candidates and fake news sites ([OFAC](#)). Recorded Future documented over 300 CopyCop websites built in 2025, at least 35 U.S.-facing, run by an American in Moscow with GRU support and generating content with self-hosted uncensored Llama-3 variants rather than Western AI services ([Recorded Future](#)). A Bloomberg investigation summarized by Meduza in April 2026 counted 190-plus fabricated Storm-1516 stories since 2023, output doubling in the first quarter of 2026, and noted that a 2023 fabrication about Zelensky associates buying yachts was later repeated publicly by the Vice President ([Meduza](#); Bloomberg original paywalled).

Matryoshka. ISD found the campaign impersonated more than 80 organizations, used AI voice cloning in about 40% of videos, and got one false USAID-celebrity claim past 4.2 million views ([ISD](#)). Reporting in September 2026 describes voice-cloned celebrity videos with fake CNN logos attacking Democrats before the midterms, spread on X, Bluesky and TikTok with minimal engagement ([Archyde](#), secondary; original outlets blocked retrieval; celebrity names UNVERIFIED).

The Pravda network and “LLM grooming.” This is the operation most relevant to anyone who asks a chatbot about politics. NewsGuard found the Pravda network published 3.6 million articles in 2024 across roughly 150 domains, and that ten leading chatbots repeated its false claims 33.55% of the time when tested, with 56 of 450 responses linking directly to Pravda pages ([NewsGuard](#); vendor). DFRLab found about 40,000 English-language Pravda articles in Common Crawl by November 2025, up from 37 a year earlier, and showed a Russian “biolab” article could be reproduced almost verbatim by an open model through text completion; inclusion in a crawl does not prove training use ([DFRLab](#)). The intent is not to reach readers. It is to be in the corpus when the model answers you.

2026 additions. OpenAI disrupted a Russian operation in August 2026 promoting a fake Israel-based think tank through U.S.-facing Telegram channels, low engagement ([OpenAI](#)); Meta removed the related assets (\$6,400 in ads). The EU sanctioned twelve individuals and two entities for information manipulation on December 15, 2025 ([Council of the EU](#)).

China

Spamouflage / Dragonbridge / Taizi Flood. Meta's August 2023 takedown of 7,704 Facebook accounts, which it called "the largest known cross-platform covert influence operation," linked the network to Chinese law enforcement ([The Record](#)). Microsoft documented AI-generated memes, fake audio, deepfake news anchors, and "polling questions" on immigration, race and drugs used to map U.S. voter demographics, with "little evidence these efforts have been successful" ([Microsoft, April 2024](#)). In the 2024 cycle the network posed as American voters and soldiers ([NPR/Graphika](#)) and, as "Taizi Flood," targeted down-ballot candidates who opposed pro-China policy, naming Rep. Barry Moore and Senators Blackburn and Rubio, with antisemitic and corruption messaging ([Microsoft, Oct 2024](#)). ODNI's public assessment was that China used AI to amplify divisive U.S. topics but that no AI operation targeting U.S. voting outcomes was identified ([NPR](#)).

OpenAI's China-origin takedowns, 2025-2026. June 2025: "Uncle Spam" generated polarized U.S. tariff content from both sides and ran fake U.S.-veteran accounts critical of the administration; "VAGue Focus" built personas to approach U.S. senators; one banned user claimed to work for the CCP propaganda department (unverified by OpenAI) ([OpenAI, June 2025](#)). June 2026: two PRC-linked clusters, "Tech and Tariffs" and "Data Center Bandwagon," generated comments and cartoons on U.S. tariffs and pushed the claim that AI data-center buildouts raise family electricity bills, posting through accounts posing as Americans, with operator instructions to depict Trump but never Xi; OpenAI's assessment: "Neither campaign appears to have gained much authentic engagement" ([OpenAI](#)). This is the direct link back to Issue 4: a real domestic grievance, farmed.

TikTok. The divest-or-ban law was signed April 24, 2024 ([Pub. L. 118-50](#)). The Supreme Court upheld it on January 17, 2025 on the "decidedly content agnostic" data-collection interest, declining to rest on the covert-content-manipulation rationale; Justice Gorsuch wrote that "one man's covert content manipulation is another's editorial discretion" ([opinion](#)). After four enforcement extensions, [EO 14352](#) (September 25, 2025) deemed a proposed deal a qualified divestiture, requiring under 20% foreign-adversary ownership and retraining of "all recommendation models, including algorithms, that use United States user data." The joint venture closed January 22-23, 2026 with Oracle, Silver Lake and MGX at about 45%, ByteDance at about 19.9%, and the algorithm licensed and retrained on U.S. data ([Axios](#), secondary). Post-closing compliance findings: UNVERIFIED.

Not included. Salt Typhoon is a telecom-intrusion campaign; no fetched primary source ties it to information operations.

Iran

Storm-2035. Microsoft found four fake news sites (a liberal-leaning "Nio Thinker" and a conservative-leaning "Savannah Time" among them) using generative AI to rephrase stolen content, plus spear-phishing of a presidential campaign official in June 2024 ([Microsoft, Aug 2024](#)). OpenAI banned the accounts generating its articles and comments, which posed as

both progressives and conservatives, and reported “low to no engagement” ([OpenAI](#)). The network was back in OpenAI’s June 2025 report batch-generating tweets on U.S. immigration.

Hack-and-leak. DOJ indicted three IRGC employees on September 27, 2024 for compromising Trump-campaign accounts and sending stolen material to Biden-campaign associates and media outlets “in a deliberate effort to ... undermine” the campaign; State offered \$10 million ([DOJ](#)). Treasury sanctioned the IRGC’s Cognitive Design Production Center on December 31, 2024 for working “since at least 2023 to incite political tensions in the United States” ([OFAC](#)).

The 2026 war. After U.S.-Israeli strikes on Iran began on February 28, 2026, Recorded Future documented Iranian networks pivoting within 24 hours to AI-produced pro-regime content: “Lego” videos of Trump and Netanyahu, an AI “Khamenei Is Back” video, fabricated footage of the USS Abraham Lincoln on fire, and a Storm-2035 shift from divisive Western content to regime messaging ([Recorded Future](#)). Cyabra counted 47 inauthentic accounts generating “over 40 million views of AI-generated content” depicting U.S. military funerals ([Cyabra](#); vendor). Graphika tracked a persona claiming breaches of the FBI director’s devices and a deepfake of Trump “begging” for help ([Graphika](#)). On August 27, 2026 Meta removed an Iran-run network of fake U.S. activists in Washington, San Diego and Atlanta using AI memes on anti-Republican, Israel-Palestine and immigration themes and tagging real journalists ([Axios](#); [Meta](#)).

Israel

STOIC / “Zero Zeno” (2024). OpenAI and Meta disrupted a Tel Aviv political-marketing firm’s operation that used ChatGPT to generate comments and ran 510 Facebook and 32 Instagram accounts with AI-generated profile photos, targeting the U.S. and Canada with “relatively little reach” ([OpenAI](#); [CyberScoop on Meta](#)). The New York Times reported, citing four current and former officials, that Israel’s Ministry of Diaspora Affairs allocated about \$2 million and hired the firm, and that the fake accounts targeted Black Democratic lawmakers including Hakeem Jeffries, Raphael Warnock and Ritchie Torres; the ministry denied it ([Times of Israel on NYT](#); [NPR](#)).

2025-2026 registered campaigns. These are disclosed under FARA, so they are not covert in the legal sense; they are here because the filings and reporting describe influencer, AI-targeting and mass-text tactics whose audiences were not told who paid. Sludge documented FARA registrations in September 2025 for at least three new U.S. firms working for Israel’s Foreign Ministry through the PR firm Havas, at least \$10 million combined, including Brad Parscale’s Clock Tower X at \$6 million through December 2025 for “5,000 variants” of creative monthly and 50 million paid impressions a month on TikTok, Instagram and YouTube, with a stated goal of shaping outputs of AI systems such as ChatGPT ([Sludge](#)). The Jerusalem Post reported the “Esther Project,” a Delaware LLC managing an influencer network at up to \$900,000, funded from a December 2024 coalition allocation of \$150 million for public diplomacy ([JPost](#)). The Wall Street Journal reported in July 2026, as

summarized by Ynet and the Times of Israel, that the Clock Tower X contract had grown past \$45 million; that millions of AI-generated texts were sent to U.S. phones under the name “Friends for Peace” by a firm paid at least \$6.5 million; that a \$3 million-plus campaign geofenced megachurches to reach Christian college students; and that roughly three dozen Americans had registered as foreign agents for Israel ([Ynet](#); WSJ original paywalled; figures as reported by these outlets). Separately, Meta removed an Israel-based commercial network in H1 2026 that used “AI to mass-produce contextually relevant comments,” including on the New York City mayoral race; Meta did not attribute it to the Israeli government ([Meta](#)).

Not included. AIPAC and other registered lobbying: no fetched primary source ties them to covert influence operations. Lobbying is legal and disclosed and is a different thing from what this part documents.

United States

The Pentagon’s anti-Sinovac campaign. Reuters found that from spring 2020 to mid-2021 the U.S. military ran at least 300 X accounts (plus Facebook and Instagram) pushing #Chinaangvirus (“China is the virus” in Tagalog) and messages such as “the VACCINE also came from China, don’t trust China!” at Filipinos, later expanding to Central Asia and the Middle East with claims that vaccines contained pork gelatin. It began under the Trump administration with the Defense Secretary’s approval and was halted by the Biden White House in spring 2021; a senior defense official acknowledged the military “engaged in secret propaganda to disparage China’s vaccine in the developing world”; the contractor later won a \$493 million psychological-operations contract ([Al Jazeera on Reuters](#); Reuters original blocked retrieval). The target was foreign, not American; it is here because it is the best-documented U.S. covert influence operation of the period and it used the same fake-persona tradecraft as everything above.

“Unheard Voice.” Stanford and Graphika analyzed five years of pro-Western covert accounts removed by Twitter and Meta, using GAN faces and fake outlets; “the vast majority of posts ... received no more than a handful of likes” ([Graphika](#)). The Pentagon ordered a review of military information operations in response ([Washington Post](#)).

Deepfake procurement. Special Operations Command’s 2022 procurement list sought deepfake capability for “influence operations, digital deception, communication disruption, and disinformation campaigns” ([The Intercept, 2023](#)); a 2024 JSOC wish list sought AI-generated personas with “Government Identification quality” photos and selfie-video layers built to defeat detection ([The Intercept, 2024](#)).

Dismantling the defenses. The State Department’s counter-disinformation office (the former Global Engagement Center, about 40 staff and a \$51.9 million appropriation) was eliminated April 16, 2025 ([MIT Technology Review](#)). The FBI’s Foreign Influence Task Force was disbanded in February 2025 and criminal FARA enforcement narrowed to “conduct similar to more traditional espionage” ([CyberScoop](#)). CISA lost election advisers, ended funding for the state election-security information-sharing center, and shrank from about 3,400 to 2,500 staff ([Brennan Center](#); [CBS](#)). ODNI’s Foreign Malign Influence Center was

“reduced and absorbed” in August 2025 ([Just Security](#)), and election-threat executives for the midterms were named only on May 14, 2026 ([The Record](#)). On July 9, 2026 the President removed the three remaining Election Assistance Commission members, leaving it without a quorum ([NPR](#)). The election-interference sanctions emergency (EO 13848) was renewed on August 29, 2025 ([Federal Register](#)), so the sanctions tool remains; the people who built the cases mostly do not.

Others

North Korea’s AI-assisted IT-worker infiltration is a revenue and fraud scheme with no fetched source tying it to influence operations ([TechCrunch on DOJ](#)). An April 2026 FDD memo alleges a Qatari-aligned “fact-checking” outlet with AI voiceovers and limited U.S.-facing content; the attribution rests on staff and hosting data and FDD is an advocacy think tank; no platform or government attribution was found ([FDD](#)). No primary source was located attributing a U.S.-targeting influence operation to Saudi Arabia, the UAE, Venezuela or India in 2024–2026. Absence of a located source is not evidence of absence.

How each actor uses AI

Use	Russia	China	Iran	Israel	U.S. military
Text at scale	ChatGPT (Doppelganger, 2024); self-hosted uncensored Llama-3 (CopyCop, 2025)	Spamouflage; Uncle Spam; Tech and Tariffs; Data Center Bandwagon (2024–26)	Storm-2035 (2024–25); SEO rewriting on fake sites	Zero Zeno (2024); “5,000 variants/month” via GPT tools (FARA filings)	Not documented
Deepfake video/ audio	Storm-1516 Harris/ Walz; CGE (Treasury); Matryoshka voice clones (2026)	Taiwan fake audio; deepfake anchors	2026 war videos; fake USS Lincoln footage	Not documented	Procurement requests only
Fake personas with AI faces	ANO Dialog diaspora personas (2026)	GAN photos; fake U.S. veterans	Storm-2035 AI photos; Aug 2026 Meta network	STOIC reused AI photos	JSOC wish list; Unheard Voice GAN faces
LLM grooming	Pravda: 3.6M articles/yr; 33.55% chatbot repetition; ~40k in Common Crawl	Not documented	Not documented	Filings describe sites built to shape “AI platform outputs”	Not documented
AI mass texting	Not documented	Not documented	Not documented	“Friends for Peace” (WSJ via Ynet)	Not documented

Operation, sponsor, funding, aim

Operation	Sponsor as attributed	Funding stated in a primary document	Aim regarding U.S. politics
Doppelganger / Good Old USA	Russian Presidential Administration via SDA, Structura, ANO Dialog	Not stated	Reduce Ukraine support; boost Republican-aligned narratives in six swing states
RT / Tenet Media	RT	~\$10M (\$9.7M in wires)	Amplify divisive U.S. content on immigration, inflation, foreign policy
Storm-1516 / CopyCop / CGE	GRU-linked	Not stated	Discredit Harris/Walz; delegitimize elections; 2026 targeting of Democrats
Pravda network	Russia-aligned	Not stated	Shape chatbot answers on Ukraine and U.S. policy
Spamouflage / Taizi Flood	PRC Ministry of Public Security-linked	Not stated	Sow division; attack China-critical candidates of both parties
Tech and Tariffs / Data Center Bandwagon	PRC-linked	Not stated	Polarize tariff and AI-infrastructure debates
Storm-2035	IRGC-linked	Not stated	Divide voters; Gaza-centered messaging; later, undermine war support
IRGC hack-and-leak	IRGC	Not stated	Damage the Trump campaign
STOIC / Zero Zeno	Israel Ministry of Diaspora Affairs (NYT)	~\$2M (NYT)	Pressure Democratic lawmakers, especially Black members, to back Israel
Clock Tower X / Esther / Sparkfire / Show Faith	Israel Ministry of Foreign Affairs (FARA-registered)	\$6M → \$45M+; up to \$900k; \$6.5M; \$3M+	Rebuild support among young conservatives and evangelicals
Pentagon anti-Sinovac	U.S. Department of Defense	Contractor later won \$493M psyop contract	Foreign audiences; undermine China
NH Biden robocall	Domestic consultant	\$150 production; \$6M FCC fine	Suppress primary turnout

What U.S. law actually does about it

FARA requires agents of foreign principals to register and disclose; it was the charging vehicle in the Tenet case, and it is why Israel's 2025–26 campaigns are public. Since February 2025 DOJ limits criminal FARA cases to espionage-like conduct. The Doppelganger seizures used money-laundering, trademark and IEEPA authorities, not a disinformation

statute, because there is no disinformation statute. Sanctions under EO 13848, 14024 and 13694 freeze assets; they do not remove content. The TikTok law is the only statute that has forced a structural change to a platform, and the Supreme Court upheld it on data grounds alone. The FEC declined an AI rulemaking in 2024 and then lost its quorum; there is no federal disclosure rule for AI political ads. The FCC's robocall ruling covers AI voices on the phone; its broadcast-ad disclosure rule has no confirmed final action. Thirty or thirty-one states have election-deepfake laws depending on who counts, and the December 2025 preemption order's carve-outs do not protect them. The New Hampshire case shows the domestic pattern: a \$6 million fine the defendant says he will not pay, a jury acquittal, and a civil judgment.

Dissection of the layer as a whole. Denatured claim: "Foreign governments are running AI-enabled operations to shape U.S. political opinion." ACCURATE, confidence High; indictments, sanctions and platform reports from multiple independent sources converge. Denatured claim: "Those operations are changing election outcomes." INDETERMINATE; every cited assessment reports low authentic engagement, and no source measures effect on votes. Denatured claim: "Only [Russia / China / Iran / Israel] does this." FALSE; the record shows five states including the United States using the same tradecraft. Denatured claim: "The U.S. has dismantled its defenses against this." ACCURATE as to the named units; the sanctions authority and DOJ's criminal tools remain.

Part III — The domestic layer: where Americans get political information, and the “95% unverified” claim

This project started with a working assumption that something like 95% of what most Americans see about politics is unverified. That assumption was run through the same method as everything else. It did not survive. What follows is what the numbers actually support, and then the domestic currents that live in the gap.

Where the information comes from

53% of U.S. adults get news from social media at least sometimes; the platforms they regularly use for news are Facebook (38%), YouTube (35%), Instagram (20%), TikTok (20%) and X (12%) ([Pew, Aug 2025](#)). TikTok’s share has gone from 3% in 2020 to 20%, and 43% among adults under 30 ([Pew](#)). 21% regularly get news from news influencers, with no partisan difference (Republicans 21%, Democrats 22%), rising to 38% among 18-to-29-year-olds ([Pew](#)). 9% get news from AI chatbots often or sometimes; 75% never ([Pew, Oct 2025](#)), though 49% now use chatbots for something, up from 33% in 2024, with no partisan gap ([Pew, Feb 2026](#)).

Who makes the influencer content: Pew’s 2024 study of 500 news influencers found that 77% “have no affiliation or background with a news organization,” and that 27% identify as conservative or pro-Trump against 21% liberal or pro-Harris ([Pew, Nov 2024](#)). That is a fact about the creators, not about whether any given post cites a source; Pew does not publish a “share of posts without a source” figure and none was found.

Trust: 28% of Americans trust mass media a great deal or a fair amount, a record low; Republicans 8%, independents 27%, Democrats 51% ([Gallup, Sept 2025](#)). The Reuters Institute puts U.S. trust in news at 25%, and 15% among right-leaning Americans ([DNR 2026](#)).

Exposure and confusion: 42% say they often come across inaccurate news (Republicans 48%, Democrats 38%) and 51% find it difficult to tell what is true (Republicans 56%, Democrats 45%) ([Pew, Oct 2025](#)). 53% are not confident they can tell whether something was made by AI ([Pew, Sept 2025](#)). Among the minority who get news from chatbots, about half at least sometimes see news they think is inaccurate, and a third find it hard to tell what is true ([Pew, Oct 2025](#), above).

The chatbots themselves: NewsGuard’s audit found ten leading chatbots repeated false news claims 35% of the time in August 2025, up from 18% a year earlier, because the models stopped declining to answer ([NewsGuard](#); vendor, not peer-reviewed). Its January 2026 audit reported “more than 28%” ([NewsGuard](#)). NewsGuard counts 3,749 sites publishing AI-

generated “news” with no meaningful human oversight as of June 2026 ([NewsGuard](#); vendor). Read these next to the Pravda findings in Part II: the poisoning is documented on the supply side, and the repetition is documented on the output side.

The “95%” claim, dissected

Denatured claim: “About 95% of the political content the U.S. population consumes is unverified.”

Atomization: (a) a share of political content (b) consumed by the population (c) is unverified. Type: statistical. Verifiability: contested. Load-bearing: yes, for the framing of this project.

Referent reconstruction: the closest real seeds are the 77% of news influencers with no newsroom affiliation, the 53% who get news from social media at all, the 51% who cannot tell what is true, and the viral but misattributed claim that “90% of online content will be AI-generated by 2026,” which is not in the Europol report it is usually pinned to ([TVNewsCheck](#)). The smallest distortion is taking a figure about creators or about consumer confidence and restating it as a figure about content.

Domain audit: wrong denominator (creators vs. posts vs. impressions), vague quantifier (“unverified” is undefined), and no measurement exists. No peer-reviewed or government estimate of the synthetic or unsourced share of U.S. political feed content was found, and vendor estimates (Cyabra, Copyleaks, Originality.ai) use proprietary classifiers on campaign-specific samples that cannot be generalized.

Verdict: INDETERMINATE-PENDING-SOURCE, confidence Insufficient. Not FALSE; unmeasured. The number should not be used.

Supportable replacement: “Most Americans now get at least some news from platforms where the dominant producers are unaffiliated with any newsroom, and roughly half say they cannot reliably tell what is true.” Every clause of that sentence has a Pew page behind it.

Domestic currents that intersect the ten issues

These are documented items, both parties, with the record next to each.

Election-fraud claims. The 2020 claims persist. The Campaign Legal Center’s case log documents the post-election suits decided on the merits, all against the challengers, and the “over 60 court cases” count ([CLC](#)). In March 2026 an executive order directed a national citizen list and restricted mail-ballot delivery to pre-approved voters; on June 25, 2026 a federal judge blocked those provisions for 24 jurisdictions, finding “No law enacted by Congress delegates authority to control mail-in voting to USPS” ([Votebeat](#)). Amplified principally by Republican officials, including the President.

Party-organ deepfakes. The NRSC’s AI Schumer video (October 2025) and the Collins campaign’s AI Ossoff audio (November 2025), both labeled, are in Issue 2. No equivalent Democratic party-organ item was found; claims about which side “leads” are UNVERIFIED.

Vaccine and health misinformation intersecting with policy. On November 21, 2025 the CDC's autism page was changed to say studies "have not ruled out the possibility that infant vaccines cause autism"; the HHS Secretary confirmed he ordered it; KFF Health News notes "upward of 25 large studies" finding no link; Senator Cassidy (R-La.) called any contrary statement "wrong, irresponsible, and actively makes Americans sicker" ([KFF Health News](#)). Democratic senators demanded reversal. Amplified by an administration official; opposed by members of both parties.

The Epstein files. February 2025: the Attorney General said a client list was "sitting on my desk right now." July 7, 2025: a DOJ/FBI memo said Epstein "did not maintain a 'client list'" and no further disclosure was warranted; prominent right-leaning figures attacked the reversal ([PBS](#)). November 18, 2025: the House passed the Massie-Khanna transparency act 427-1 and the Senate cleared it by unanimous consent hours after the President reversed his opposition ([NPR](#)). NPR documented amplification on both sides: the President and the FBI director had earlier amplified Epstein conspiracy theories, the President later said Democrats "worked with Epstein," and opponents shared redacted filings out of context to claim doctoring; DOJ warned that a fake letter was circulating ([NPR, Jan 2026](#)). About 3 million pages were released January 30, 2026 ([Britannica timeline](#)). This is the cleanest recent example of a real document set being used as a projection screen by everyone at once.

Democratic-side false claims documented by fact-checkers. Senator Sanders's "15 million thrown off" health-care claim was rated Mostly False (Issue 8). A Pants on Fire rating of a Michigan Senate candidate's claim about an opponent's "\$14 million payout" was reported in July 2026 but the PolitiFact page was not fetched (UNVERIFIED).

AI hype in both directions. The "AI 2027" superintelligence scenario circulated widely in 2025-26 and drew rebuttals; public opinion has moved toward pessimism (71% expect fewer jobs; 39% say AI does more harm than good). No fact-checker finding on a specific hype claim was located; this is context, not a documented falsehood. The method applies to doom and utopia alike: a prediction is a predictive claim, unfalsifiable until its date, and its author's incentives are part of the audit.

Dissection of the layer. Denatured claim: "Americans are consuming a large volume of political content whose provenance they cannot assess, and both parties' officials contribute false or misleading claims to it." ACCURATE, confidence High for the first clause (Pew, Gallup), Medium for the second (fact-checker record is uneven in coverage). Denatured claim: "One party is responsible for misinformation." FALSE; the documented record has officials of both parties amplifying false claims, with different volumes on different topics, and no source measures the totals.

Part IV — The method: how to dissect a sourceless political claim yourself

Everything above was produced with one procedure. It is short enough to memorize. Use it on the next post that makes you angry.

Rules. Never fabricate a citation. Keep what the post asserts, what you know, and what you infer in separate piles. Bill numbers need a Congress number. Unsourced is not false; it lowers confidence, not truth value. No counter-spin. Private individuals are out of scope. Separate falsifiable from unfalsifiable; motive claims usually cannot be checked, so classify them and move on.

Stage 0, intake. Restate the core assertion in one neutral sentence with the adjectives and intensifiers removed. That is the denatured claim. Note the implied time, actors, jurisdiction and source of authority.

Stage 1, atomization. Split it into the smallest claims that can each be true or false. Tag each with a type (event, vote, statutory content, procedure, quote, causal, statistical, predictive, evaluative, motive), a verifiability level (primary, secondary, contested, unfalsifiable), and whether the post collapses if that atom fails.

Stage 2, referent reconstruction. The claim almost always has a real seed. Find up to three candidates. Name the smallest distortion that turns the seed into the post: procedural vote to substantive, committee to floor, introduced to passed, one chamber to “Congress,” executive order to statute, proposed rule to enacted, state to federal, projection to count, stay order to ruling, old event to current. Then run the structural impossibility check: wrong timeline, chamber lacks the power, procedure does not exist, body not in session. This is the one step you can complete without a source.

Stage 3, domain audit. Check the standard failure patterns: bill title cited instead of text; “voted against X” from an omnibus or procedural vehicle; motion to recommit framed as a policy vote; CBO score without baseline or window; cherry-picked start date, wrong denominator, level versus rate, nominal versus real; a real quote stripped of context; satire laundered as reporting; anonymous sourcing chain.

Stage 4, argument audit. Reconstruct premises and conclusion including the unstated ones. Name the fallacies precisely (straw man, false dilemma, post hoc, motte-and-bailey, argument from ignorance, and so on), give the exact span, the mechanism in one sentence, and a severity: minor, material, disqualifying. Note rhetorical devices: smuggled presuppositions, scare quotes, agentless passive, vague quantifiers, false balance.

Stage 5, verdict. On the denatured claim only: ACCURATE, ACCURATE-BUT-MISLEADING, PARTIALLY-ACCURATE, MISLEADING, FALSE, STRUCTURALLY-IMPOSSIBLE, UNFALSIFIABLE, or INDETERMINATE-PENDING-SOURCE. Confidence: High (institutional reasoning settles it), Medium (strong referent match, needs one confirmation), Low (multiple readings survive), Insufficient (withhold). Never round INDETERMINATE up to FALSE.

Stage 6, retrieval plan. Primary sources in priority order: Congress.gov, the House Clerk and Senate roll-call pages, the Congressional Record, committee reports, the Federal Register, GAO/CBO/CRS, agency releases, court opinions, official transcripts. Write three to seven literal search queries. Name the single decisive artifact. Say what each possible result would change.

Tone. Clinical. Short sentences. If the claim is fine, say so in one line.

Worked example

The source list this project began with was run through the method before anything else was built. Denatured claim: the 2024 Republican and Democratic platforms are the current ones and are available in full from the parties and the American Presidency Project; independents have no platform; Ballotpedia, Congress.gov, GovTrack, Vote Smart and Pew provide nonpartisan context. Fourteen atoms. Two load-bearing atoms confirmed against live pages (the APP adoption note; the democrats.org platform page). One overstatement found: “parties release new platforms every four years” is contradicted by the 2020 Republican re-adoption cited in the same text. One attribution imprecision: roll-call votes originate with the House Clerk and Senate.gov, not Congress.gov. One omission: the Democratic platform predates the candidate change. Verdict ACCURATE, confidence High, three edits before publication. All three were made in this document.

Appendix — What was not confirmed

Items marked UNVERIFIED in the body, collected so a reader can close them: current status of the AI Safety Institute successor body; FEC quorum status as of September 2026; final status of the FCC broadcast AI-disclosure rule; a primary document for the 15% H2O revenue arrangement; exact justice alignment in Trump v. Barbara; the December 11, 2025 Senate roll-call numbers on ACA credits; the underlying district-court date in Louisiana v. FDA; case status of the RT/Tenet defendants; dollar figures for the Center for Geopolitical Expertise's AI infrastructure; the EU listing date for John Mark Dougan; celebrity names in the September 2026 Matryoshka reporting; post-closing TikTok joint-venture compliance findings; the 2025 Intercept SOCOM follow-up; NewsGuard's May 2026 headline rate; the PolitiFact page on the Michigan Senate claim; a 2025-26 party split on election deepfakes; a 2025-26 measure of Section 230 awareness; the Marquette party percentages on ICE.

Sources

Every link in the body is a source. The research memoranda behind this document, with the full URL lists, are stored in the project as `research/issues.md`, `research/disinfo.md` and `research/ecosystem.md`.